

Instructor: ..... Date: .....

Learner: ..... Regional Branch: .....

Program: ..... Center: .....

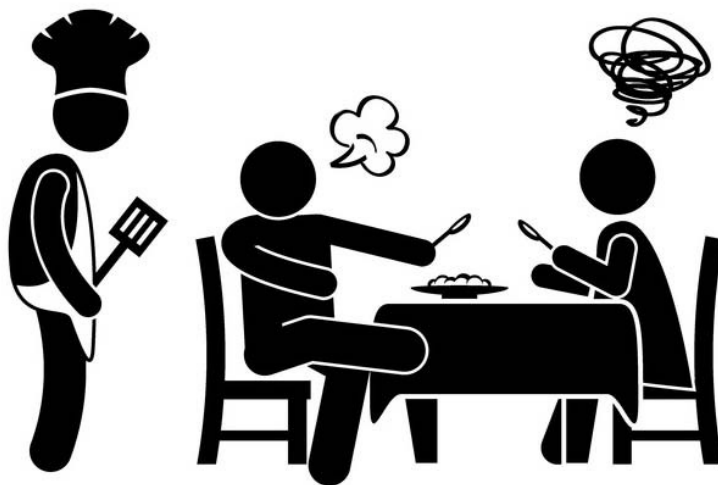
## CONTENT

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### Let's Start!

What kind of customer are you?



## Learning Outcome

Describe emotions and feelings in present and past situations in spoken or written texts and in work and social contexts.

### Ask your partner:

- What do you think of customers who are being difficult?
- How would you react if you didn't receive proper service in a restaurant?

## Can Do Statements

- I can talk about work and dealing with customers.
- I can express that a fairly certain condition will be fulfilled using when or if.
- I can express criticism using can, could, might, should.





## Let's Explore!

Vanessa talks to her employees about **indecisive\***, challenging, and aggressive customers.

\* If you are "*indecisive*", you are unable to make clear decisions or choices.



*Instructions: Read the text aloud.*

You should anticipate encountering difficult people and try to serve them as best you can. When dealing with challenging customers, you should remain professional and calm. You shouldn't cause a scene. When you interact with a difficult customer, you will require a certain amount of tact. For you to effectively serve an angry customer, you might want to be especially polite. If you are successful, you move beyond the emotional reaction to find the reason for their anger.

There are many reasons for customers to be dissatisfied or unhappy when you meet them. Perhaps they were improperly served by you or one of your co-workers in the past. Even if you were not personally involved in their previous experience, you represent the restaurant. If they aren't happy with the service, you are considered "just like that last server." This may seem unfair but you could make an attempt to make these customers happy.

Customers can be rather demanding or domineering at times. Sometimes domineering behavior is a personality type, or it could be a temporary reaction to past customer service experiences. It can be challenging and frustrating to try to meet the needs of a demanding and indecisive customer.

Some customers seem to go out of their way to be aggressive or to get attention. Outwardly, they seem confident and self-assured, but they may be insecure and defensive and this may be reflected in their behavior. Behavior they might exhibit includes: yelling, using profanity, demanding angrily to speak to a manager, being verbally abrupt (snapping at you) while you're trying to help them, ignoring what you say, or insulting you or the restaurant.



## Let's Practice!

Vanessa talks about serving customers.

*Instructions: Circle the correct word to complete the sentences. Read them aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.*

1. You should **to anticipate** / **anticipate** encountering difficult people and try to serve them as best you can.
2. When dealing with challenging customers, you should **remain** / **remaining** professional and calm.
3. There are many reasons for customers to be **dissatisfied** / **satisfied** or unhappy when you meet them.
4. Perhaps they **were** / **be** improperly served by you or one of your co-workers in the past.
5. Even if you were not personally involved in their previous experience, you **representing** / **represent** the restaurant.



## Let's Practice!

Vanessa and Alexander talk about customer service.

*Instructions: Complete the text below by choosing from the options that you are given. Read the complete sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.*

|                    |                                                |                                             |                                 |                                                |                                |
|--------------------|------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| <b>1</b>           | <b>2</b>                                       | <b>3</b>                                    | <b>4</b>                        | <b>5</b>                                       | <b>6</b>                       |
| Why<br>How<br>When | are requiring<br>won't require<br>will require | If you are<br>If you will be<br>If you will | will be moving<br>move<br>moved | If they aren't<br>They aren't<br>When they are | will be moving<br>moved<br>are |

1. \_\_\_\_\_ you interact with a difficult customer, you 2. \_\_\_\_\_ a certain amount of tact. 3. \_\_\_\_\_ successful, you 4. \_\_\_\_\_ beyond the emotional reaction to find out the reason for their anger. 5. \_\_\_\_\_ happy with the service, you 6. \_\_\_\_\_ considered "just like that last server".





## Extension Activity

Write a letter as an unhappy general manager of a hotel.

*Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.*

- You work for a large hotel chain. The company values your work and you have been transferred to a new location that has been having some problems: as the general manager of the hotel, you are quite unhappy and even frustrated with what you have been noticing at this hotel.
- Brainstorm problems that might occur at a hotel.
- Write a letter to one of your friends back home/ at your old job.
- Include details about what has frustrated you and made you unhappy at your new job. (You work at a hotel, so be creative when it comes to reasons!)
- Remember to write in a letter format with appropriate greetings and closings.
- Read your letter to a classmate.
- Hand in your letter to your teacher after you've made any necessary corrections.

### Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I discuss various problems that might be bothersome at a hotel.

☐ ☐

I write a letter to a friend about my new job.

☐ ☐

I use appropriate greetings and closings.

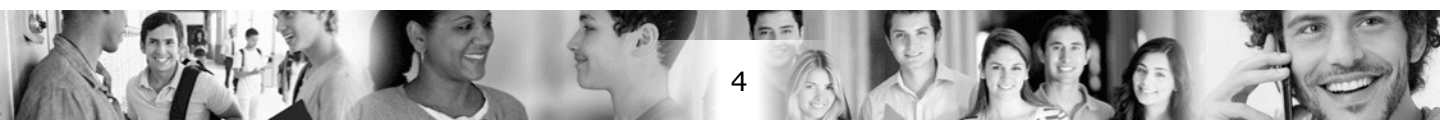
☐ ☐

I read my letter to a classmate.

☐ ☐


## Target Words

- dissatisfied** (adjective): not satisfied because something is not as good as you had expected  
e.g. There are many reasons for customers to be dissatisfied or unhappy when you meet them.
- improperly** (adverb): in an inappropriate way  
e.g. Perhaps they were improperly served by you or one of your co-workers in the past.
- domineering** (adjective): the quality of trying to control other people  
e.g. Customers can be rather demanding or domineering at times.
- go out of their way** (expression): to try very hard to do something  
e.g. Some customers seem to go out of their way to be offensive or to get attention.
- demanding** (adjective): expecting a lot of attention or expecting to have things exactly the way you want them  
e.g. It can be challenging and frustrating to try to meet the needs of a demanding and indecisive customer.
- self-assured** (adjective): calm and confident about what you are doing  
e.g. Outwardly, they seem confident and self-assured, but they may be insecure and defensive and this may be reflected in their behavior.
- to exhibit** (verb): to clearly show a particular quality, emotion, or ability  
e.g. Behavior they might exhibit includes: yelling, using profanity, or demanding angrily to speak to a manager.





## Learning Points

### First Conditional: If and When to Talk about Real-Life Situations

The Zero Conditional is used to talk about what you usually do in real-life situations. The result of the condition is always true according to the initial situation. You use the First Conditional with if-clauses to exchange opinions about possible future outcomes.

The Zero Conditional is also called the Present Real Conditional. It is used to talk about a situation that is always true when a general condition is met.

You use the structure:

**If/when** ... *Simple Present*, ... *Simple Present* or *Simple Present* ... **if/when** ... *Simple Present*

Both *if* and *when* are used in the Present Real Conditional. Using *if* suggests that something happens less frequently. Using *when* suggests that something happens regularly.

You use the First Conditional to say it's possible that you will or will not do something. In that condition, something else may, may not, will or will not happen. The outcome is not in the present, but in the future.

Structure:

*If + Present Simple ... will + verb ...*

### Examples:

- *When you interact with a difficult customer, you will require a certain amount of tact.*
- *If you are successful, you move beyond the emotional reaction to find out the reason for their anger.*
- *If they aren't happy with the service, you are considered "just like that last server."*





## Learning Points

### Modals to Express Criticism: Can, Could, Might, Should

You can use the modals *can*, *could*, *might* or *should* to express disapproval in the present or in the past.

You use *can*, *could*, *might* or *should* + *Infinitive* to express criticism or disapproval in the present or in the future.

#### Examples:

*You can be really annoying sometimes!*

*Our waiters could step up a little more!*

You use *can*, *could*, *might* or *should* + *Perfect Infinitive* to express criticism or disapproval about a past situation.

#### Examples:

*You could have tried to solve this problem before it became too big.*

*You really should have consulted me on this.*

#### Examples:

- *You shouldn't cause a scene.*
- *You might want to be especially polite.*
- *You could make an attempt to make these customers happy.*
- *Customers can be rather demanding or domineering at times.*

